Whenever someone says they have "a cool trick," take them outside and slap them up.

➤ *Jim Weirich (1956–2014)*

APPENDIX 3

Spell Book

This appendix is a "spell book"—a quick reference to all the "spells" in the book, in alphabetical order. Most of these spells are metaprogramming related (but the ones from Appendix 1, *Common Idioms*, on page 217, are arguably not that "meta"). Each spell comes with a short example and a reference to the page where it's introduced. Go to the associated pages for extended examples and the reasoning behind each spell.

The Spells

Around Alias

Call the previous, aliased version of a method from a redefined method.

```
class String
  alias_method :old_reverse, :reverse

  def reverse
    "x#{old_reverse}x"
  end
end

"abc".reverse # => "xcbax"
```

For more information, see page 134.

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Remove methods from an object to turn them into *Ghost Methods* (57).

```
class C
  def method_missing(name, *args)
    "a Ghost Method"
  end
end
```